R&D | RetailPulse

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Executive Summary and Presentation Template

> **In simple words**
>
> This document gives fill-in templates for the executive summary, the slides, the dashboard walk-through and the questions you will be asked.

1. One-page executive summary (template)

Part	Write here
Question	In one sentence: where is demand hard to predict, and what should we do?
Answer in one line	[N] families cause [Y]% of forecast error. Errors rise in [period/event]. We recommend [main action].
Finding 1	[Headline + number + comparison]
Finding 2	[Headline + number + comparison]
Finding 3	[Headline + number + comparison]
Recommendation 1	[Action, owner, priority]
Recommendation 2	[Action, owner, priority]
Recommendation 3	[Action, owner, priority]
What we cannot say	[Baseline is simple; no cost data; reasons are likely, not proven]

2. Story structure

Part	Meaning	Your project
Situation	What is normal	Stores need to forecast demand every day
Complication	What goes wrong	Forecasts miss in certain places and times
Question	What we asked	Where, when and which way do we miss?
Answer	What we found and recommend	Top families, periods, direction, actions

3. Slide plan (8 slides)

#	Slide	Headline (write as a sentence)	Visual
1	Title	Where demand is hard to predict: a forecast error study	Title and project name
2	Why it matters	Wrong forecasts lead to excess stock or empty shelves	One simple graphic
3	The big picture	Overall accuracy is [X]%, with a bias of [Y]%	KPI cards
4	Which families	[N] families cause [Y]% of the error	Pareto chart
5	Which way	[Family group] over-forecast, [group] under-forecast	Excess vs shortfall bars
6	Where and when	Error is highest in [places] and during [periods]	Region chart and month chart
7	Why (likely)	The baseline breaks on [holidays, promotions, paydays]	Holiday vs regular chart
8	What to do	Three actions, with owners and priority	Action table

4. Dashboard walk-through script

Time	What to say
30 seconds	Page 1 only: overall accuracy, top families, the main message.
2 minutes	Pages 1, 2 and 4: which families, which way, when it breaks.
5 minutes	All pages, then Page 5 actions. Invite questions.

5. Questions you will be asked

Question	Good answer approach
Why did you use a simple baseline?	The data has no company forecast. A baseline shows where demand is hard to predict, and anyone can understand it.
Can I trust these numbers?	Name the checks: totals match SQL, holiday join tested, missing dates handled.
Why WAPE and not MAPE?	Many rows have zero sales. MAPE breaks on zero. WAPE does not.
What would it be worth in money?	The data has no price or cost. I measured units. With cost data I could convert.
What would you do next?	Try the better baseline per family, add promotion plans, track weekly.

6. GitHub README outline

1. Title and one-line summary
2. Business problem and decisions
3. Data and tools (PostgreSQL, Power BI)
4. Method (baseline, metrics)
5. Top 5 insights with screenshots
6. Recommendations
7. Limits
8. How to run the SQL scripts

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